

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/12: 1. Sources of ethical guidance map

CENTRAL FOCUS

1. Sources of ethical guidance map

[1] Conscience signals an internal moral concern.

|
v

[2] Family and social learning shape early moral judgment.

|
v

[3] Professional ethics articulate occupational values.

|
v

[4] Conduct codes specify institutional expectations.

|
v

[5] Service rules govern defined official conduct.

|
v

[6] Regulations operate under delegated legal authority.

|
v

[7] Statutes establish binding public legal standards.

|
v

[8] Constitutional limits test all public authority.

|
v

VERDICT -> Treat the sources as interacting checks, not as a mechanical ladder that legalises every compliant act.

ANSWER USE -> Use for an opening definition map before resolving a law-rule-conscience conflict.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/12: 2. Law, rule, regulation and instruction

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2. Law, rule, regulation and instruction

[1] Start with constitutional competence and rights.

|
v

[2] Identify the parent statute and its purpose.

|
v

[3] Locate any delegated rule-making power.

|
v

[4] Check whether a valid rule applies.

|
v

[5] Identify regulator-made regulations, if any.

|
v

[6] Separate circulars and guidelines from regulations.

|
v

[7] Check service-rule or contractual adoption of codes.

|
v

[8] Record the instrument's actual legal force.

|
v

VERDICT -> Never call every office instruction a law or every guideline delegated legislation.

ANSWER USE -> Use in the 2020 laws-versus-rules answer and in rule-of-law case studies.

MUST REMEMBER: Constitution, statute, delegated legislation, service rule, code,...

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/12: 3. Legality, ethics and propriety

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3. Legality, ethics and propriety

[1] Ask whether the actor has legal authority.

|
v

[2] Check compliance with applicable rule and procedure.

|
v

[3] Identify the public purpose of the power.

|
v

[4] Test fairness and equal treatment.

|
v

[5] Map foreseeable harms and benefits.

|
v

[6] Check conflicts, gifts and appearance of bias.

|
v

[7] Assess trust and institutional precedent.

|
v

[8] State a qualified ethical-propriety verdict.

|
v

VERDICT -> Technical legality is necessary but does not exhaust ethics or propriety.

ANSWER USE -> Use to structure a legal-but-unethical example without implying that ethics overrides law.

EVIDENCE / AUTHORITY / APPLICATION LIMIT: For Snowden or Indian vigilance examples,...

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/12: 4. Ethics in making rules

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4. Ethics in making rules

[1] Define the legitimate public objective.

|
v

[2] Identify affected groups and unequal burdens.

|
v

[3] Choose authority consistent with the parent law.

|
v

[4] Make criteria intelligible and transparent.

|
v

[5] Test proportionality of restrictions and sanctions.

|
v

[6] Build access and accommodation where authorised.

|
v

[7] Provide reasons, appeal and review mechanisms.

|
v

[8] Revise after evidence of exclusion or harm.

|
v

VERDICT -> Ethics improves legitimacy, fairness and implementation; it does not create delegated power.

ANSWER USE -> Use for the second half of 2020 GS-IV Q4(a).

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/12: 5. Constitutional morality in administration

CENTRAL FOCUS

5. Constitutional morality in administration

[1] Identify the constitutional value in issue.

|
v

[2] Check competence and legal authority.

|
v

[3] Protect equality and non-arbitrariness.

|
v

[4] Respect dignity and affected-person voice.

|
v

[5] Follow due process and fair hearing.

|
v

[6] Give intelligible public reasons.

|
v

[7] Resist majoritarian or partisan pressure.

|
v

[8] Accept competent review and correction.

|
v

VERDICT -> Constitutional morality disciplines both majority pressure and private preference.

ANSWER USE -> Use for the 2019 and 2025 constitutional-morality routes.

CLOSE DISTINCTION: A crisis of conscience is a serious conflict among justified...

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/12: 6. Calibrating conscience

CENTRAL FOCUS

6. Calibrating conscience

[1] Notice the moral alarm or discomfort.

|

v

[2] Collect facts instead of acting on impulse.

|

v

[3] Name the affected stakeholders and harms.

|

v

[4] Check personal bias and incomplete information.

|

v

[5] Identify applicable law and service rules.

|

v

[6] Test constitutional values and public purpose.

|

v

[7] Consult a competent institutional channel.

|

v

[8] Record a revisable reasoned conclusion.

|

v

VERDICT -> Conscience is an ethical signal that becomes reliable through evidence and public reasoning.

ANSWER USE -> Use for 2023 GS-IV Q5(a) and conscience-based case studies.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/12: 7. Crisis of conscience response ladder

CENTRAL FOCUS

7. Crisis of conscience response ladder

[1] Define the instruction and moral conflict precisely.

|
v

[2] Verify facts, law and seriousness of harm.

|
v

[3] Reflect and seek ethical or legal clarification.

|
v

[4] Place a factual written objection on record.

|
v

[5] Seek recusal only where authority permits it.

|
v

[6] Escalate to a competent superior or oversight body.

|
v

[7] Report verified wrongdoing through available channels.

|
v

[8] Consider resignation only after grave unresolved complicity.

|
v

VERDICT -> Use the lowest effective accountable channel, not silent compliance or immediate public defiance.

ANSWER USE -> Use in the 2019 crisis-of-conscience answer and public-service dilemmas.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/12: 8. Civil disobedience versus institutional dissent

CENTRAL FOCUS

8. Civil disobedience versus institutional dissent

[1] Citizen identifies an unjust law or policy.

|
v

[2] Civil resistance is public and communicative.

|
v

[3] Non-violence limits coercive harm.

|
v

[4] Acceptance of consequence signals principled protest.

|
v

[5] Public servant holds delegated official authority.

|
v

[6] Office duty requires records and confidentiality.

|
v

[7] Dissent begins with review and escalation channels.

|
v

[8] External action needs necessity and proportionality.

|
v

VERDICT -> Do not import the citizen's civil-disobedience model unchanged into public-service office duties.

ANSWER USE -> Use to distinguish principled resistance from unaccountable disclosure.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/12: 9. Whistleblowing and protected channels

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9. Whistleblowing and protected channels

[1] Identify evidence of serious wrongdoing or harm.

|
v

[2] Separate fact from policy disagreement or grievance.

|
v

[3] Preserve material lawfully and confidentially.

|
v

[4] Assess immediate public-interest urgency.

|
v

[5] Use the least compromised competent recipient.

|
v

[6] Verify current protection and confidentiality scope.

|
v

[7] Document retaliation risk and requested safeguard.

|
v

[8] Seek independent review of response or inaction.

|
v

VERDICT -> Whistleblowing is evidence-based public-interest reporting, not an automatic entitlement to leak.

ANSWER USE -> Use for the 2022 protection route and conscience-to-accountability answers.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/12: 10. Snowden-type external disclosure test

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10. Snowden-type external disclosure test

[1] Specify the alleged public wrong.

|
v

[2] Verify evidence and credibility of the concern.

|
v

[3] Map privacy, transparency and security values.

|
v

[4] Assess realistic internal oversight channels.

|
v

[5] Test whether those channels are inadequate.

|
v

[6] Consider narrower authorised disclosure alternatives.

|
v

[7] Minimise avoidable harm to uninvolved persons.

|
v

[8] Give a qualified necessity-proportionality verdict.

|
v

VERDICT -> A serious conscience claim strengthens only when method, necessity and proportionality also withstand scrutiny.

ANSWER USE -> Use for 2018 GS-IV Q12 without treating the question's legal claims as settled facts.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/12: 11. Form, substance and reasoned discretion

CENTRAL FOCUS

11. Form, substance and reasoned discretion

[1] Identify the statutory or scheme purpose.

|
v

[2] Read the applicable rule and its exception.

|
v

[3] Establish relevant facts and affected interests.

|
v

[4] Check whether equivalent compliance is authorised.

|
v

[5] Treat similarly placed persons alike.

|
v

[6] Reject ultra-vires or selective waiver.

|
v

[7] Record authority, alternatives and reasons.

|
v

[8] Enable audit, appeal and judicial review.

|
v

VERDICT -> Substance corrects mechanical literalism only within authority, equality and review safeguards.

ANSWER USE -> Use for 2024 Q4(b) and discretionary welfare or procurement cases.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/12: 12. Answer-writing synthesis

CENTRAL FOCUS

12. Answer-writing synthesis

[1] Define the precise source-of-guidance issue.

|
v

[2] Distinguish law, rule, regulation and code.

|
v

[3] Identify constitutional value and legal authority.

|
v

[4] State the ethical harm or public-interest concern.

|
v

[5] Test conscience against facts and bias.

|
v

[6] Choose institutional channel and safeguard.

|
v

[7] Use a named Indian administrative illustration.

|
v

[8] Conclude with a qualified accountable verdict.

|
v

VERDICT -> High-scoring answers combine ethical sensitivity with lawful, evidence-based institutional action.

ANSWER USE -> Use as the final revision checklist for theory questions and case studies.